

“I agree,” he said, as he felt a burden lift from his shoulders. “You know, it’s funny, we’re totally broke and facing bankruptcy, but I finally feel free. Maybe you have to hit bottom before you can begin to look up.”

“I know this sounds crazy, but maybe we can use this as an opportunity to witness for the Lord. Why don’t you go to each of the creditors and ask them not to force you into bankruptcy. Tell them that we intend to pay back every dime of the money, if they’ll work with us.”

“How can we do that?” Bud asked, looking at his wife with an air of appreciation. “We’re dead broke, and I lost my license.”

“Then it’s really up to the Lord to do it, isn’t it?” Sandi asked.

“Well, you’re right, it does sound crazy. But it’s also kind of exciting. If any of the creditors are crazy enough to go along with us, it could really be a testimony to God’s greatness. I’ll just tell them the truth. If they join in the bankruptcy, they probably won’t get anything. After all, the first and second mortgage will wipe out any money from the house, and the cars are leased. I’ll start calling first thing tomorrow.”

Bud went to each of the creditors, most of whom were banks holding deficiency agreements on the property loans, and asked them not to force him into bankruptcy. When he was asked how he would ever repay the money he owed, he responded, “I don’t know, but if the Lord chooses to bless us, I’ll repay every dime—if you don’t join in the bankruptcy action. In the meantime I’ll get a job and pay you what I can each month.”

Bud’s biggest creditor was the largest bank in town. Based on the current value of the land they had foreclosed, the bank estimated Bud owed them over \$400,000. He met with the bank president (a former client) and asked him not to join in the bankruptcy action.

“But, Bud, I have a responsibility to our stockholders,” was the banker’s reply. “If you’re hiding any assets and we don’t join the lawsuit, I could be sued for negligence.”